

# Switching to IPv6?

## Here are Some Must-Try Options!

It is practically impossible and not particularly desirable to replace all your existing computing and networking equipment with IPv6 equipment at once. But what is expected from IT managers today is that when they buy new IT equipment during routine technology upgrades or while the business scales up, they can ensure that the equipment is IPv6-ready.



It's high time for us to make way for IPv6 as the revolution has finally arrived in India. The Indian Registry for Internet Names and Numbers (IRINN) has begun issuing the next version of Internet addresses, 'IPv6', which would allow security agencies to identify each Internet user based on the different IP address given to them.

The Internet addresses under the present version IPv4 (Internet Protocol version 4) are limited and service providers often assign a single IP address to many users. "The number of IPv6 addresses available is enormous. ISPs (Internet Service Providers) can allocate an IP address to each of their users. People can be easily identified if they are using IPv6," said Sanjaya, director, Services and Operations, APNIC, which is one of the five bodies authorised to issue Internet addresses, and is recognised by the IRINN for issuing IP addresses in India. So, now is the time for you to get ready for IPv6.

The Internet has become indispensable for business and governance, worldwide. Some reports claim that as many as 2 billion individuals connect to the Net every day. The enormous popularity and increasing adoption of the Internet has led to a shortage of Internet Protocol (IP) addresses needed to uniquely identify each device that accesses the Internet. Running out of Internet addresses would have disastrous worldwide consequences, as the ability to add and connect new devices would come to a halt. A new and much larger type of address known as IPv6 avoids this issue.

IPv6 has become a norm across the globe. But the IPv6 address is not compatible with the existing IPv4 structure. Further, it's not possible or economically desirable to replace all networking equipment and all devices to IPv6 all at once. What's needed are solutions that allow IPv6 to co-exist with the existing IP address type, IPv4, and